

IN CONTEXT

German Expressionism

Schoenberg's atonal music formed part of the wider cultural movement of Expressionism that developed in Germany and Austria in the early 20th century. Expressionist painters such as Emil Nolde, Franz Marc, and Egon Schiele depicted tortured inner feelings, nightmares, and ecstatic visions through the use of distorted lines and lurid colors. The movement was loosely associated with the psychoanalyst Sigmund Freud's exploration of dreams, sexuality, and the unconscious, which was taking place in Vienna at the same time. Schoenberg's most overtly Expressionist works included *Pierrot Lunaire* and *Erwartung*.



SELF-PORTRAIT WITH CHINESE LANTERN,
EGON SCHIELE, 1912

Arnold Schoenberg (or Schönberg) was born in the Jewish